

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Pramod Mahajan

Address: 5 Avenue Road Belmont SM2 6JE

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Dear Planning Officer,

I write to formally object in the strongest possible terms to planning application DM2025/01591 concerning the proposed change of use and extensions at the former Ambulance Station, Dorset Road, Belmont.

My objection is based on serious concerns relating to highway safety, traffic generation, impact on vulnerable children, overdevelopment of the site, and unsuitability of the location for the proposed intensified mixed use.

****1. Severe Traffic and Highway Safety Concerns****

The proposal would intensify the use of this site significantly. A place of worship and community hub typically generate concentrated peak-time traffic, particularly during evenings and weekends. Dorset Road and the surrounding residential streets are not designed to accommodate high visitor volumes or event-based traffic surges.

The site is located close to the busy A217, a major and heavily trafficked route. Vehicles entering and exiting the site in higher numbers will add pressure to an already constrained highway environment, increasing congestion and the risk of collisions.

Furthermore, Brastead Close is not a through road. Increased traffic is likely to result in turning movements, reversing, and informal manoeuvring within narrow residential streets, creating

additional danger and disturbance for existing residents.

****2. Proximity to Avenue Primary Academy - Safeguarding Concerns****

The site lies in close proximity to Avenue Primary Academy. This is a critical concern.

School drop-off and pick-up times already generate substantial pedestrian and vehicle activity in the immediate area. Introducing a use that could attract significant numbers of visitors, including during overlapping hours, will materially increase risk to young and vulnerable children.

The safety of children must be given paramount consideration. Increased traffic movements, on-street parking pressure, and larger gatherings of adults in close proximity to the school raise legitimate safeguarding and public safety concerns.

****3. Overdevelopment and Scale****

The proposal includes a part one, part two-storey front and side extension and an increase in height to part of the building. This represents a substantial intensification compared to the former ambulance station use.

The cumulative impact of:

- * Change of use to mixed F1 and F2
- * Increased built mass and height
- * Higher footfall and visitor numbers
- * Additional servicing and refuse activity

amounts to overdevelopment of a constrained residential site.

****4. Parking Stress and Residential Amenity Impact****

Places of worship frequently generate parking overspill into surrounding residential roads when on-site capacity is insufficient. This area is already sensitive due to school-related parking demand.

Overspill parking would:

- * Obstruct driveways
- * Reduce visibility at junctions
- * Impede emergency vehicle access
- * Increase neighbour conflict and nuisance

Cycle storage provision does not mitigate the realistic expectation that most visitors will arrive by car.

****5. Noise and Disturbance****

Community hubs and places of worship can involve amplified speech, evening events, gatherings, and high visitor turnover. This is materially different from the previous ambulance station use and would erode the quiet residential character of the area.

****6. Inappropriate Location for Intensified Assembly Use****

This site sits within a residential context with constrained access arrangements. It is not positioned within a town centre, high street, or area designed to accommodate large-scale community assembly uses. The proposal is therefore fundamentally unsuited to its surroundings.

In summary, this application presents:

- * Significant highway safety risks
- * Direct impact on vulnerable school children
- * Overdevelopment of a constrained site
- * Increased congestion near a major road (A217)
- * Residential amenity harm
- * Inadequate infrastructure to support the scale of use proposed

For these reasons, I respectfully request that the Council refuse this application.